

LESSON 11: DEFENSE – REASONING AND DEDUCTION



1



REMEMBER THE BIDDING:

- Reconstruct the declarer's hand from the auction
- Points shown + promised distribution

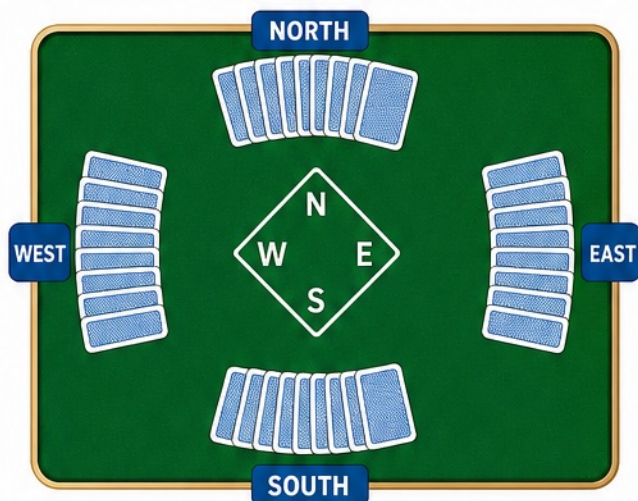
EXAMPLE AUCTION			
WEST	NORTH	EAST	SOUTH
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♥
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
Pass	Pass	Pass	(All Pass)

2



ANALYZE THE FIRST TRICK:

- Which card did partner play? (signal)
- Which card did the declarer play? (deduction)



3



DO NOT ESTABLISH CARDS FOR THE DECLARER:

- Do not play Aces on small cards
- Wait for the right moment to take

4



UNDERSTAND THE PLAY PLAN AND COUNTER IT:

- If the declarer wants to ruff → play trumps!
- If the declarer wants to establish → cut the links!

5



MAINTAIN THE SAME LENGTH AS THE DUMMY:

- If the dummy has 4 Hearts, keep 4 Hearts
- "Keep what the dummy keeps"

THE 5 STEPS OF THE THINKING DEFENDER

1



REMEMBER THE BIDDING

Reconstruct the declarer's hand from the auction.

2



ANALYZE THE FIRST TRICK

Look at partner's card (signal) and the declarer's card (deduction).

3



DO NOT ESTABLISH CARDS FOR THE DECLARER

Do not play Aces on small cards. Wait for the right moment to take.

4



UNDERSTAND THE PLAY PLAN AND COUNTER IT

If the declarer wants to ruff → play trumps!
If the declarer wants to establish → cut the links!

5



MAINTAIN THE SAME LENGTH AS THE DUMMY

If the dummy has 4 Hearts, keep 4 Hearts. "Keep what the dummy keeps."



THINK, OBSERVE, DEDUCE!

Good defenders don't guess. They think, observe and take the right actions!

Maestro Franci